The Katipunan and the Cry of Pugad Lawin

The Katipunan

The Kataas-taasang, Kagalang-galangang Katipunan ng mga Anak ng Bayan, or simply the Katipunan, was a secret society founded in Tondo, Manila, on July 7, 1892, the same week Jose Rizal was arrested and sent into exile in Dapitan. Its goal was independence from Spain through revolution. Andres Bonifacio was one of its founders and became its Supremo, or supreme leader. Emilio Jacinto, the youngest of its leaders, wrote the Kartilya ng Katipunan, the society's code of conduct. Members signed their oath in their own blood.

Discovery of the Katipunan

On August 19, 1896, the Spanish authorities discovered the Katipunan after a member told a Spanish friar about the society. Arrests began in Manila. Bonifacio and his men left the city and gathered in the hills north of Caloocan to decide what to do.

The Cry of Pugad Lawin: August 23, 1896

According to this handout, the Cry happened on August 23, 1896, at Pugad Lawin, in what is now Quezon City. Bonifacio and about a thousand Katipuneros tore up their cedulas, the community tax certificates that showed they were subjects of Spain, and shouted for independence. This handout follows the account of Pio Valenzuela, who was there, and the date of August 23 is the one used in the official commemoration today.

Why it matters

Tearing the cedulas was a public break from Spanish rule. It marked the start of the Philippine Revolution of 1896. The first major battle followed a week later, at San Juan del Monte on August 30, 1896.